

Step-by-Step Guide to Report Deepfake Cases in India

Step 1: Document the Deepfake Content

Make sure you have clear evidence of the deepfake:

- Screenshots or screen recordings of the deepfake.**
- The URL or location where the content is hosted.**
- The date and time you discovered the deepfake.**
- If the deepfake involves someone else, have any personal details of the victim (with their consent).**

Step 2: Verify the Deepfake

You can use online tools to verify whether the content is indeed a deepfake.

Some tools you might try:

- Microsoft Video Authenticator (detects deepfakes in videos).**
- Deepware Scanner (checks for deepfakes).**

Step 3: Report to the Platform or Social Media

If the deepfake was shared on a social media platform (e.g., Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, YouTube):

- Report the content using the platform's in-built reporting features.**
 - For Facebook/Instagram, click on the three dots on the post and choose "Report."**
 - On YouTube, click on the three dots and select "Report" > "Harassment or bullying" or "False information."**
 - On WhatsApp, forward the message to their support team (through WhatsApp settings > Help > Contact Us).**

Step 4: Contact Local Authorities and Cybercrime Units

In India, cybercrimes related to deepfakes may be reported to the local police or the Cyber Crime Cell. Here's how to do it:

- **File an FIR (First Information Report):** Visit the local police station and report the issue. Many police stations in India now have a dedicated cybercrime unit that deals with online offenses.
- **Cyber Crime Portal:** You can also lodge a complaint online through the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal at <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>. This is especially useful for incidents that involve fraud, harassment, or identity theft.
- **Cyber Crime Cells:** Many states have specific cybercrime cells that can take action in cases of online harassment or identity-related crimes. You can look up the contact details of the cybercrime unit in your state.

Step 5: Report to CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team)

If you believe that the deepfake content is part of a larger cybersecurity threat (e.g., phishing, online fraud), you can report the incident to CERT-In, which is India's national cybersecurity agency.

- Visit their website: <https://www.cert-in.org.in/>

Step 6: Consult a Cybersecurity Expert or Digital Forensic Specialist

If the situation is more complicated or you need additional help (such as forensics to trace the creator of the deepfake), consider hiring a cybersecurity expert or digital forensics consultant.

Step 7: Consult with a Lawyer (if Needed)

If the deepfake involves defamation, identity theft, or harassment, it may be

worth consulting with a cyber lawyer.

Step 8: Follow Up

- Stay in touch with the police or the relevant authorities to track the progress of the case.
- Request updates from the platform where you reported the content to ensure it gets removed.

Step 9: Prevention (For Future Incidents)

Once you've dealt with the immediate issue, you may want to take steps to protect yourself or others from similar incidents in the future:

- Use tools like reverse image search (e.g., Google Images, TinEye) to check if your photos or videos have been used elsewhere.

Legal Framework for Deepfakes in India:

India has several laws that could apply to deepfake cases:

- Section 66E of the IT Act: Deals with violation of privacy, including image or video manipulation.
- Section 354C of the IPC: Covers "voyeurism" (creating or sharing videos/images without consent).
- Section 500 of IPC: Defamation (if the deepfake is used for harm or to defame someone).

Additional Resources:

- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: <https://cybercrime.gov.in/>
- Cyber Crime Police Stations in India: Contact details can usually be found online for each state's cyber crime unit.

Helpful Tips:

- **Keep all evidence organized and in a secure place.**
- **Act quickly, as deepfakes can spread rapidly and may cause significant harm.**